

LA Olympics induction big shot in the arm for Indian compound archers

Past success in compound archery doesn't ensure future Olympic success, but Indian archers are happy to have a chance to experience competing at the Olympics and potentially even **making the podium.**

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The tattoo on Rajat Chauhan's right forearm is nearly a decade old — a permanent source of motivation. He got it in 2015: the five interlocked rings, a reminder of his dream to compete at the Olympic Games.

At the time, the 20-year-old already had significant achievements. A year earlier, he was part of the Indian men's compound team that won gold at the 2014 Asian Games — the country's only archery gold from that tournament. Just months before getting the tattoo, Rajat won silver in the men's individual compound event at the 2015 World Championships — India's first

medal in that discipline.

Yet, soon after making history, Rajat switched disciplines, trading his compound bow for a recurve one. His reason was straightforward: Olympic archery featured only the recurve bow. If he wanted to compete at the Olympics, he had no choice but to adapt. The transition was harder than expected. After two years of middling results, Rajat returned to compound archery. He won another Asian Games medal —